Sean Kennedy
Staff Software Engineer | Infrastructure & Platform
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SUMMARY

Staff software engineer with 9+ years of experience building production software, data systems, and cloud infrastructure, with deep specialization in platform engineering and SRE. Strong in Python, Terraform, AWS, and CI/CD, with a track record of building deployment platforms, distributed data systems, APIs, and developer tooling that reduce costs, accelerate delivery, and improve reliability. Delivered six-figure cost savings and 2x–10x deployment improvements while shipping both internal infrastructure and customer-facing platform capabilities.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript, C++, Rust
Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Azure, Terraform, Kubernetes, ECS
CI/CD & Platform: GitHub Actions, CircleCI
Data: PostgreSQL, Snowflake, Trino, Alluxio
AI Harnesses: Claude Code, Codex

EXPERIENCE

Staff SRE Engineer, manifold.ai Mar. 2026 - present

- Upgraded the Terraform Snowflake provider from v0.98 to 2.x across all production customer environments with zero downtime protecting customer data from non-deterministic states and upgrade related failures
- Simplified developer onboarding by implementing Tailscale mesh network as a VPN in our core staging environment replacing fragile tunneling scripts with standardized secure access to internal services
- Reduced customer onboarding time measured in days to time measured in hours by collapsing the number of manual steps into fewer automated steps
- Enhanced Slack-based deployment failure triage with automated first-pass diagnostics, helping engineers identify likely causes faster and deployment failure investigation time.

Sr. DevOps Engineer, manifold.ai Oct. 2022 - Mar. 2026

- Owned and maintained critical components of the core platform infrastructure, including deployment tooling, initial end-to-end service rollouts, integration testing frameworks, and novel platform features
- Migrated several cloud-managed services to self-hosted infrastructure, reducing annual operating costs by ~$60K/year
- Led a major Terraform pipeline refactor, achieving 2x–10x faster deployments and significantly lowering deployment failure risk
- Led implementation of the BYOCompute feature, enabling customers to connect their own cloud accounts to the platform, directly contributing to increased product adoption

Sr. Infrastructure Engineer, CDK Global July 2020 - Sept. 2022

- Optimized a key internal microservice, reducing API response times by ~2.95 seconds

and lowering memory usage in the Kubernetes cluster
- Improved data platform performance by implementing cache invalidation and warming jobs, leading to faster load times and higher user satisfaction
- Cut data delivery time to production Snowflake environments from days to hours by building a continuous deployment pipeline integrating Git and Kafka Connect
- Achieved company-wide security SLOs by deploying ClamAV virus scanning via a custom Kubernetes Helm chart
- Accelerated delivery of Databricks notebook pipelines by developing a Python-based CI tool to manage and converge Databricks workspace job state

Sr. Data Engineer, Square Root June 2019 - July 2020

- Developed a critical SQL generation microservice, eliminating the need for external vendors and saving the company over $100,000
- Implemented a bulk API endpoint for the core data API, reducing dashboard client calls by 3–7x and enabling advanced visualization features
- Re-architected data flow for a core data science product using Alluxio distributed caching and the Trino query engine, enabling compatibility with new data stores and significantly faster queries
- Built comprehensive data quality testing tools, increasing API request coverage to 95%

Data Engineer, Square Root Oct. 2017 - June 2019

- Built a configurable file ingestion and normalization framework that improved data processing speed by ~20% and centralized previously fragmented file movement workflows
- Designed and deployed an event-based data lake ingestion service processing ~3 million events/month, enabling near real-time (≈30s latency) ingestion of physical transaction data
- Developed an internal web app used by ~40 employees to track and visualize customer feedback, transforming hard-to-quantify insights into actionable metrics and improving user engagement
- Authored data migration scripts that enabled seamless interoperability between legacy and modern data stores, supporting gradual system transition without disrupting usage

Business Intelligence Developer, Unique Influence Oct. 2014 - Oct. 2017

- Built an automated report generation system using Cron, MySQL, and Python to produce custom multi-tab .xlsx reports for 15 clients, saving over 1 hour per week per client

EDUCATION

University of Texas
Bachelor of Arts, May 2010

Austin Community College
Aug. 2015 - May 2020 (Computer Science)